INTERNAL | PREPARED FOR YOU | NOT FOR THE PERSON DESCRIBED

Mary Barra

General Motors | Chair and CEO, since 2014 | Detroit

Meeting: First introduction: earn a second meeting | Prepared for: Founder / principal | Depth: standard | Sources: 7 of 12 source types, 17 cited | Status LIMITED | Prepared Oct 13, 2026

Take. Mary Barra has led GM since 2014 [1], told investors near-term EV adoption would be lower than planned [2], is shifting Orion toward trucks and SUVs [3], and meets you five days before GM reports on Oct 20 [4]. **Evidence:** the EV reset [2] and the raised 2026 profit guidance [5]. **Action:** open on her two EV statements [6]. **Avoid:** asking about the Oct 20 numbers [4].

QUESTIONS THAT CLOSE GAPS

1. **When near-term EV adoption fell below plan [2], which GM decisions changed first, and which stayed put?**
   Decides: where your offer fits. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
2. **What does moving Orion to full-size trucks and SUVs from early 2027 [3] change for your leadership team's preparation?**
   Decides: where the gap is. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
3. **Who else shapes how GM's senior leaders prepare for outside meetings like this one?**
   Decides: who signs off. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
4. **You said people are what make General Motors [7]; where do your leaders lose the most time before big decisions?**
   Decides: the second meeting's topic. **Ask:** Mary Barra.
5. **If a 30-minute follow-up after Oct 20 [4] made sense, who from your team would join?**
   Decides: the next step. **Ask:** Mary Barra.

WHO THEY ARE

- **Role:** Chair and CEO of General Motors, CEO since Jan 15, 2014 and chair since Jan 4, 2016 [1].
- **Path:** joined GM in 1980 as a co-op student, Stanford MBA in 1990 [8]; later ran global product development [9].
- **The organization:** $48 billion in second-quarter 2026 revenue [10].
- **What changed:** $7.6 billion of EV charges in late 2025 [11]; new Silverado and Sierra reach dealers in December [12].
- **Recent wins:** raised 2026 EBIT-adjusted guidance to $14-16 billion, Jul 21, 2026 [5].

IN THEIR WORDS

- **EVs, Jan 2026 earnings:** "We continue to believe in EVs." [6]
- **People, Aug 2026 conversation with Condoleezza Rice:** "People are what make General Motors, General Motors." [7]
- **EVs and policy, Sep 2026 Fortune podcast:** covered the state of GM's business and the future of EVs in the U.S. [13]
- **Culture, 2014:** leaders must "face the brutal facts" [14]

LinkedIn: not read: you declined

SIGNALS AND WHAT TO DO WITH THEM

OBSERVABLE	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Barra: "We continue to believe in EVs" [6] while adoption sits below plan [2]	She holds belief and reset together; show you can too
Talyx offers AI meeting-prep and knowledge tools for executive teams [15]	Leaders enter outside meetings with sourced facts
GM reports Oct 20, five days after this meeting [4]	Attention is on results; keep the ask small, after it

MEETING APPROACH

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	YOUR MOVE
Pace and control: no public observation	No read
How they take recognition: no public observation	No read
Appetite for detail: guidance in dollar ranges [5], charges split by cash and timing [11]	Headline, two proof points, a source on request.
Appetite for risk: cut EV plans [2] yet keeps the long-term bet [6]	Pair the upside with the safeguard in the same sentence.
How they take disagreement: no public observation	No read

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	YOUR MOVE
How they keep score: no public observation	No read

Evidence tier: low: it sets how far page 3 goes

WHO DECIDES

- **Decision maker:** Not determined
- **The gate:** Not determined
- **Relationship holder:** Not determined

STRONGEST CASE AGAINST

- **Against:** the meeting lands five days before GM's Oct 20 report [4], after $7.6 billion of EV charges [11] and tariff costs of $3.5-4.5 billion [16]. **Reverses if:** her office offers a time after Oct 20.

MEETING ANGLE

This meeting

- **Frame:** how GM's leaders get ready for hard decisions, in her terms of facing the brutal facts [14]; not a pitch.
- **Lands:** "You can't build a relationship when you need it" [17].
- **Repels:** questions about quarterly numbers before Oct 20 [4].
- **What to bring:** a side-by-side of her Oct 2025 [2] and Jan 2026 [6] EV lines.
- **The ask:** 30 minutes after Oct 20 [4] with Mary Barra or the person she names · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with that person. **Stop if:** she says someone else owns this and offers no name.

Meeting two

Meeting two: a working session after the Oct 20 report [4]. **Meeting three:** the December pickup launch [12].

After the meeting

Capture: who owns leadership preparation.

EVIDENCE LEDGER

Unmarked facts are measured. 17 facts cited; status LIMITED at 7 of 12 source types.

#	WHAT IT SAYS	SOURCE	TAG	GRADE	CONF.	DATE
[1]	CEO since 2014; chair since 2016	gsb.stanford.edu	Direct	MEASURED	Primary	Oct 13, 2026
[2]	Near-term EV adoption lower than planned	finance.yahoo.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Oct 21, 2025
[3]	Orion shifts to trucks and SUVs, early 2027	wardsauto.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jul 22, 2026
[4]	Third-quarter results due Tuesday Oct 20, 2026	investor.gm.com	Search	MEASURED	Reputable	Jul 21, 2026
[5]	2026 EBIT-adjusted guidance raised to $14-16B	wardsauto.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jul 22, 2026
[6]	"We continue to believe in EVs"	fortune.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jan 27, 2026
[7]	"People are what make General Motors, General Motors"	news.gm.com	Search	MEASURED	Primary	Oct 13, 2026
[8]	Joined GM 1980; Stanford MBA 1990	gsb.stanford.edu	Search	MEASURED	Primary	Oct 13, 2026
[9]	Ran global product development and supply chain	trustees.duke.edu	Direct	MEASURED	Primary	Oct 13, 2026
[10]	Q2 2026 revenue $48 billion	wardsauto.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jul 22, 2026
[11]	$7.6B EV charges in second half of 2025	fortune.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jan 27, 2026
[12]	Silverado and Sierra reach dealers in December	wardsauto.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Jul 22, 2026
[13]	Fortune podcast with Barra on EVs and policy	fortune.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Sep 9, 2026
[14]	Leaders must "face the brutal facts"	gsb.stanford.edu	Direct	MEASURED	Primary	May 27, 2014
[15]	Talyx offers AI meeting-prep tools	profile.yaml	Yours	MEASURED	Primary	Oct 13, 2026
[16]	Tariff cost estimate $3.5-4.5 billion	finance.yahoo.com	Direct	MEASURED	Reputable	Oct 21, 2025
[17]	"You can't build a relationship when you need it"	gsb.stanford.edu	Direct	MEASURED	Primary	May 27, 2014

Coverage	7 of 12 source types · not found: GM's own description (gm.com refused the fetch), publications, registers, public posts · LinkedIn: not read: you declined
Still open	Decision maker: Who signs off on how senior leaders prepare? · The gate: What must be true before a second meeting? · Relationship holder: Who does the relationship run through? · Pace and control: How does she like a first meeting to run? · How they take recognition: Which recent result does she most value? · How they take disagreement: How does she want to be challenged? · How they keep score: Which measures does she watch most? · LinkedIn: What does she post about?
Left out on purpose	health, family, political giving, litigation, home address, personal finances
Run	Oct 13, 2026 · standard · first introduction · Founder / principal · US · LIMITED · 17 facts

MEETING SCRIPT

Facts select the moves; read the room, never the record · Mary Barra, General Motors · Prepared Oct 13, 2026

1. OPEN

- **Hook:** *You told investors that near-term EV adoption will be lower than planned [2], and in January that GM still believes in EVs [6]. I'd like to hear how you hold both.*
- **Credibility:** Talyx builds AI meeting-prep and knowledge tools for executive teams [15].
- **Insight:** This conversation was prepared with a three-page brief where every fact carries its source [15].
- **Rule:** Let the hook land, then ask the first question and stay quiet.

2. QUESTION ORDER

- **Story:** When near-term EV adoption fell below plan [2], which GM decisions changed first, and which stayed put?
- **Process:** What does moving Orion to full-size trucks and SUVs from early 2027 [3] change for your leadership team's preparation?
- **Gate:** Who else shapes how GM's senior leaders prepare for outside meetings like this one?
- **History:** You said people are what make General Motors [7]; where do your leaders lose the most time before big decisions?
- **Commitment:** If a 30-minute follow-up after Oct 20 [4] made sense, who from your team would join?

3. OBJECTIONS: NAME IT, THEN ANSWER

- **Their likely objection:** *"This is the week before we report."* Agreed; I'm asking for time after Oct 20 [4].
- **Their likely objection:** *"We already have a team for this."* Then I'd like to learn what they still lose time on [7].
- **Their likely objection:** *"Why should I spend time on this?"* Because you said to face the brutal facts [14]; I'd show you one.

4. CLOSE

- **Restate:** ask what would make a follow-up an easy yes, then say it back in her words.
- **Real deadline:** the Oct 20 report [4], before the December pickup launch [12].
- **The ask:** 30 minutes after Oct 20 with Mary Barra or the person she names · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with that person.
- **Follow-up:** send the side-by-side of her two EV statements [2][6] within a day.

5. IF IT STALLS

- **The move:** return to her Jan 2026 line, "We continue to believe in EVs" [6], and ask what the next proof point is.
- **The move:** ask who owns preparation for the December pickup launch [12].

6. GUARDRAILS

- **Rule:** promise nothing about GM's results or timing; claim only what the cited record says.
- **Never say:** "Does that make sense?" · "Is this helpful?" · "No pressure" · "You'd know better than me" · "Just checking in"

Next step: send the side-by-side of her two EV statements [2][6] on Oct 16.